

Discussion Input

What is a text discussion?

An interactive dialogue where opinions are shared to gain deeper understanding of ideas presented in a material.



What is expected in a text discussion?

CONTENT

- Show evidence of **full understanding of source materials**.
- Demonstrate effective **personalization and reflection**:

  -Give **personal and real-life examples**.

  -Refer to **movies, books**…

  -Explain your personal opinions **in detail** (synthesizing ideas from source materials and personal opinions/examples).

INTERACTION

- Demonstrate full engagement by **listening attentively**, **responding** to others' contributions, and **asking follow-up questions** throughout the discussion.

LANGUAGE

- Have a sufficient control of language to express oneself (accuracy and variety of language)

Task Guidelines:

- You will be assigned the source materials **beforehand**.

- As it is an **informed discussion**, you are expected to study the source materials before the discussion day and discuss the questions by **referring** to ideas in those sources.

- You will do the task in a group of **4 to 6 students**, depending on the class size, and **one class hour** (min. 40 min. speaking + short feedback) will be allocated for each group. Detailed feedback will be provided after the discussion.

Reminders:

- Go over the source materials and study them before joining the text discussion.
- Mind map important concepts/keyword so that you can integrate them during the discussion.
- Brainstorm some personal/real-life examples before the discussion day.
- Brainstorm some critical questions that can encourage further discussion and keep the conversation going.
- Synthesize ideas in the sources with personal examples and reflections.
- Refer to the source materials **as much as** possible. (You can bring your notes to the discussion.)
- Listen closely and follow the ideas that your friends are raising/discussing. (Take down notes.)
- Respond to your friends and ask **follow-up** or **new** questions whenever possible.
- Do **not repeat** what someone else has already said, but you may summarize or paraphrase them when you link them to **another** idea/argument.
- Do **not monopolize** the discussion. Share time equally with others. Those of you who dominate the discussion will **lose** points from interaction.
- Do **not** pass a question until you have discussed it **in depth**.
- Familiarize yourself with the text discussion **rubric** so that you know the expectations.

Some useful chunks to refer to sources

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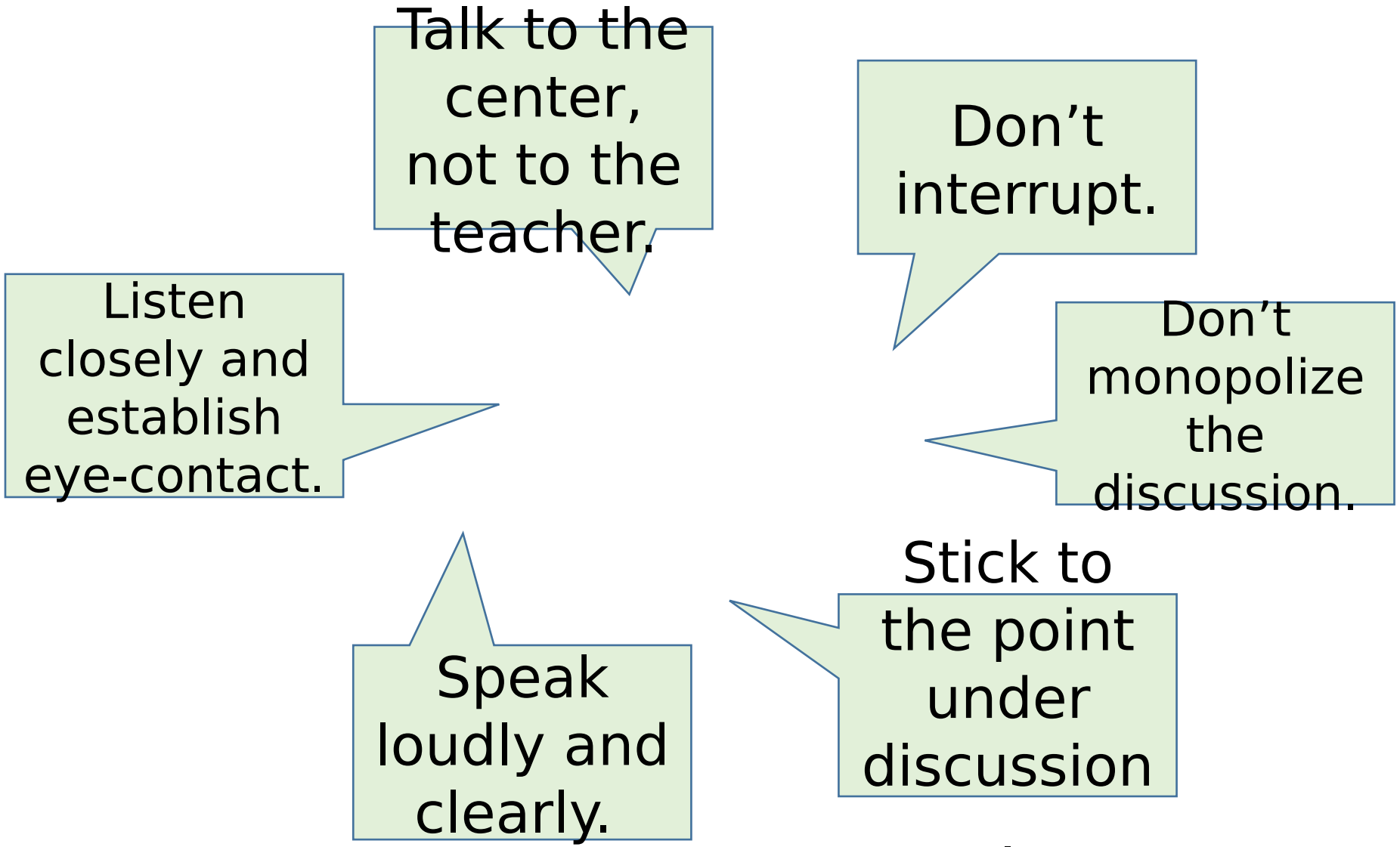
- As …… claims/mentions/argues/states in paragraph X, …
- It is mentioned in the reading/listening that …
- The author/the speaker suggests/argues/informs that …
- It can be inferred from the reading/video that …
- Based on the given information in the text/video, it is possible to claim/argue that …
- In the text written by ……., it is suggested/claimed that …

Ground Rules:

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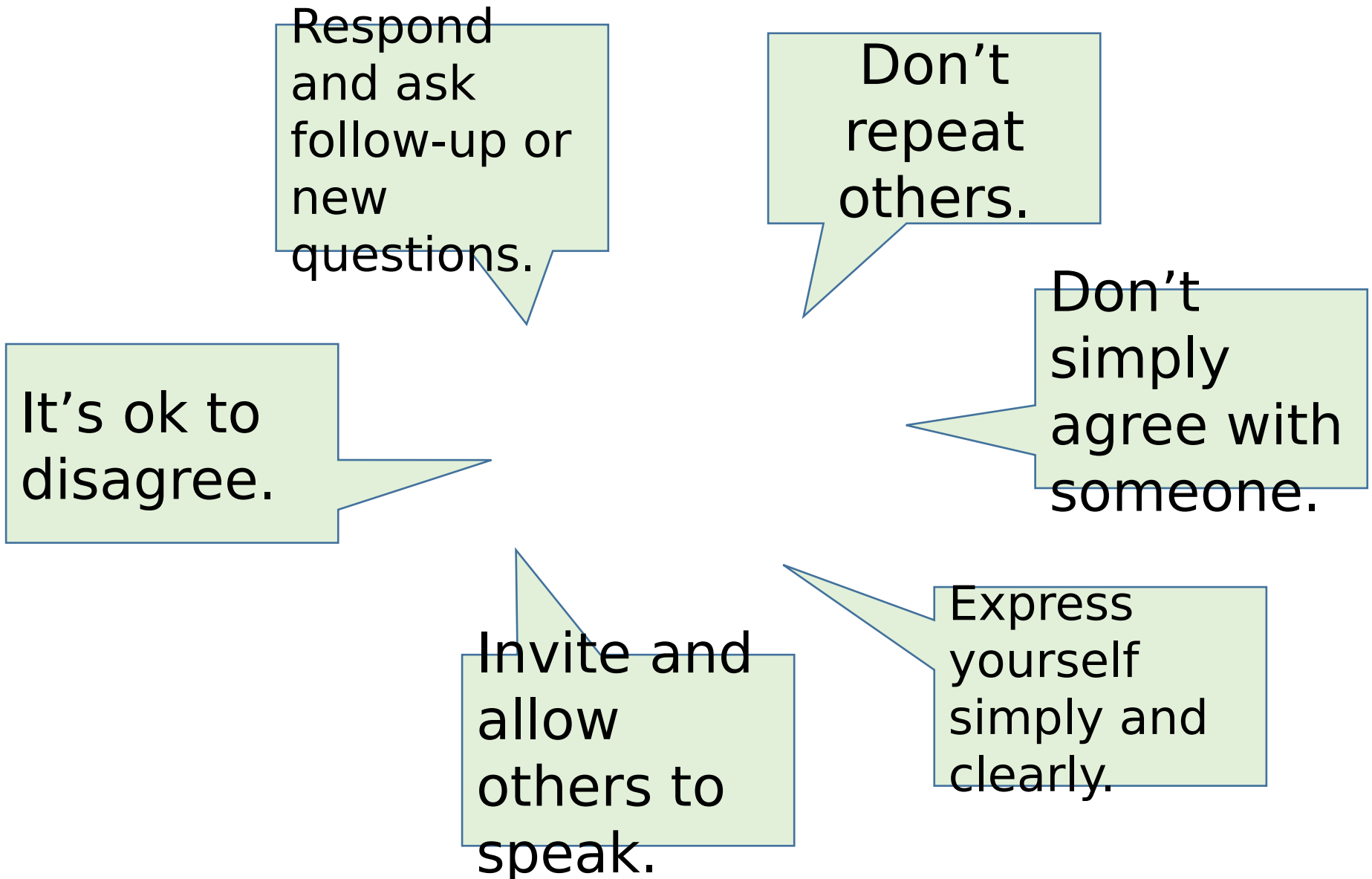
- You must be **present** in class at the specified time of the task (announced beforehand)
- If your discussion time is scheduled for Monday’s first lesson, for example, you cannot join another group without presenting a valid excuse and documentation.
- If you don’t attend the discussion(s), you get a 0 unless you have a **valid excuse**, such as a medical report.
- You must submit a copy of your medical report to your instructor **within 5 workdays after the end of the report period**. Reports submitted later than 5 workdays will not be accepted.

Discussion skills:

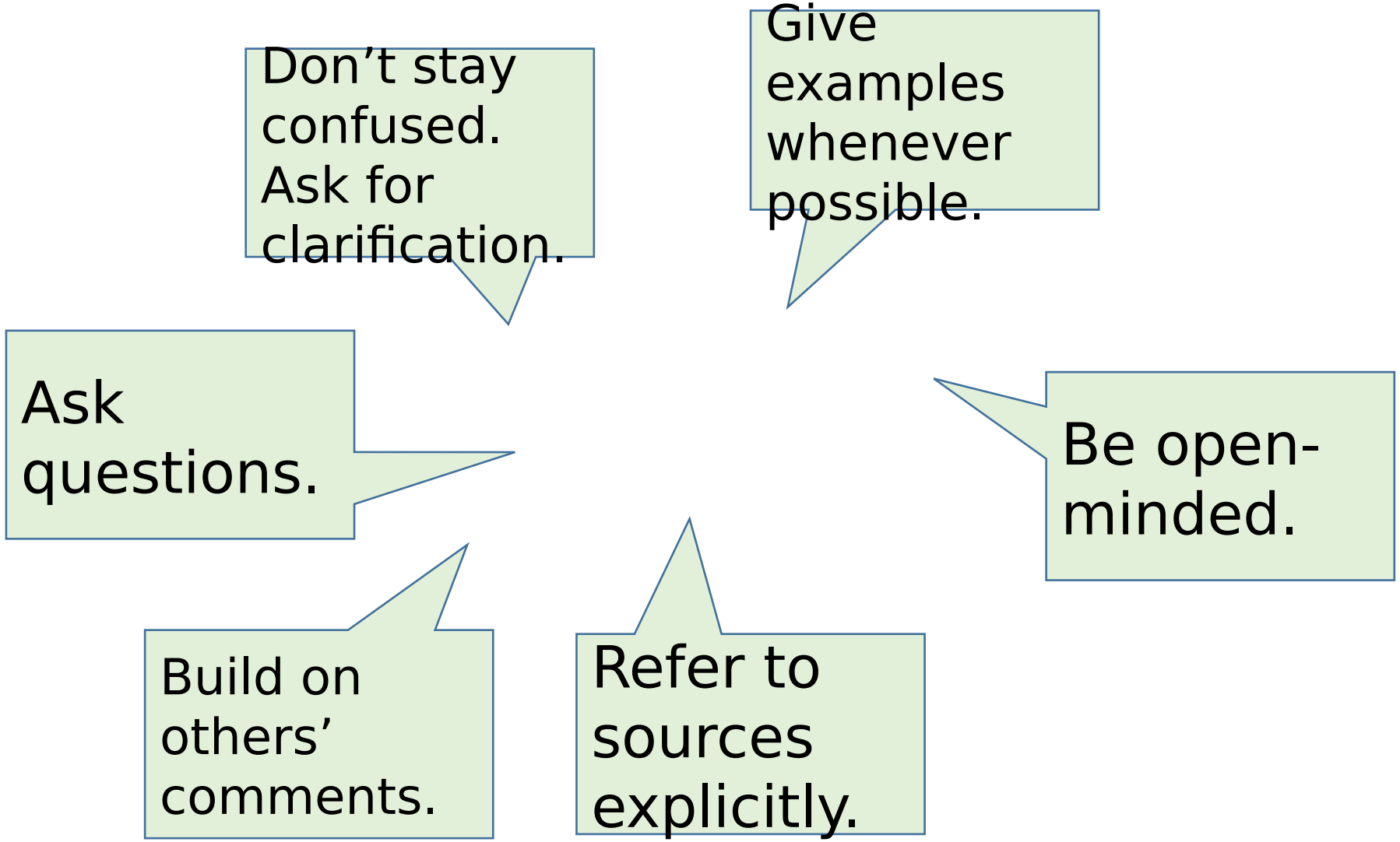


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Discussion skills:



Analysis and reasoning skills:



Civility:

Question others in a civil manner.

Use appropriate language.

Use each other's names.

Enter the discussion politely. Use turn-taking expressions.

Listen to others respectfully.

USEFUL LANGUAGE IN TEXT DISCUSSIONS

Taking the Turn	Speaking First	Taking the Turn Back Getting Back on Track
○ Can I come in (here)? ○ I'd like to make a point here… ○ May I…? ○ In fact, … ○ This may a good point to… ○ This might be the right time to say	○ Can I go ahead? ○ Can I speak first? ○ I'd like to start the discussion by… ○ May I get us started?	○ Getting back on track, … ○ To get back on topic/ to the point at hand… ○ We seem to be getting off the point.
Offering Other People the Chance to Speak	**Turning Down the Chance to Speak**	**Signaling the End of Your Turn**
○ Do you agree? ○ Do you have an opinion on…? ○ Do you think…? ○ How do you feel about…? ○ Would you agree that…?	○ I can't add anything to that. ○ I think you've covered everything. ○ I'm still thinking about what I want to say.	○ I think I've made my point ○ (I think) you get the idea. ○ That's all I want to say at this stage

USEFUL LANGUAGE IN TEXT DISCUSSIONS

Asking for More Details/Clarification	Giving Examples / Personal Experience	Building on Others' Ideas
○ I have a question about... ○ When you said... did you mean...? ○ Can someone explain....? ○ And then? ○ So? ○ What happened (then)?	○ In my experience, I have found... ○ I can relate to... because ... ○ For me, a better solution/etc. would be to ... ○ An example of ... in my life is when...	○ Building on your point... ○ Your comment leads me to think... ○ I understand your point that... ○ because/however/and...
Citing Evidence from the Text		
○ From the reading/video, I know that... ○ ...shows that...	○ When the author/speaker says... I think s/he supports that ○ An example of this is given by... /comes from...	

More Discussion Language

Expressing an opinion:

- In my opinion/view, ...
- To my mind, ...
- The way I see it/As I see it, ...
- It seems to me that ...
- As far as I know, ...
- Personally speaking, I feel ...
- As far as I'm concerned, ...
- Personally, I think/believe ...
- From my point of view/perspective, ...
- To be honest/Honestly/Truth be told, I think...
- I'd say that ...
- If you ask me,
- I might be wrong but I think ...
- I'm of the opinion that ...
- In my experience ...

Asking for an opinion:

- How do you feel about this?
- What's your view/position on ….?
- I'd be very interested to hear your opinion on this.
- Would you agree with me that …?
- What are your thoughts on …. (that)?
- You've made some interesting points. Now, let's hear from the rest of the group.
- What does everyone else think about …?
- Anyone have any ideas on ….?
- Who would like to share first?
- Before we move on, does anyone want to add/share anything?

Discussion Language:

Agreeing:

- I couldn’t agree more.
- I feel the same.
- No doubt about it/Precisely/Absolutely!
- I’m of the same opinion.
- I agree 100 percent/I 100 percent agree/A 100 percent!
- Well, I think so too!/Me too!
- I’d go along with that …

Partly agreeing:

- I see your point but …
- I kind of agree with you there that…
- I agree with you to an extent; however,
- You make a good point, but …
- I’m in two minds about this: On the one hand, …. On the other hand, maybe it’s not.
- I’m on the fence about this: ….

Disagreeing:

- I’m afraid I disagree.
- I’d be inclined to disagree.
- That’s not the way/how I see it.
- I don’t feel the same.
- Let’s agree to differ.
- I’m not sure I agree with that.
- I see it differently in that …
- I see your point/what you’re getting at but …
- Sorry, but I just can’t agree to that.
- I understand where you’re coming from, but …
- With all due respect, I’m of a different opinion/I can’t share this view.
- You could be right. However, …

Discussion Language:

Asking for clarification:

- Would you mind repeating that?
- Sorry, I didn’t catch what you said.
- Sorry, I didn’t quite hear you.

When you want to say the “opposite” of what someone else said:

- On the contrary!/Quite the contrary!/Just the opposite!
- That is actually the very opposite of what I said.
- That is quite contrary to what I said.
- I maintain the contrary.
- In contrast to what you said, I maintain that…

Making additions to comments

- I just want to follow the train of thought you brought up.
- Can I jump in for a second? I just want to add to that previous point/what was said before we move on.
- Can I jump in there?/Sorry to interrupt but could I add something here?
- If I may interject…

When you forget what to say:

- I’ve completely lost my train of thought. Hopefully, it’ll come back to me in a moment.
- Let me start over. It might come back to me in a moment.